Day 3 (stop 1 of 2) - Wetland Ridge, Margaret Kalogeropoulos, Niagara College

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Niagara section · hike 3 · Woodend Conservation Area

4.4 km / 2.7 mi	~1.2 h	3.3 km new	80 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

Park: Woodend Conservation Area: Enter from Taylor Rd, 140 m north of Warner Rd. Google Maps.

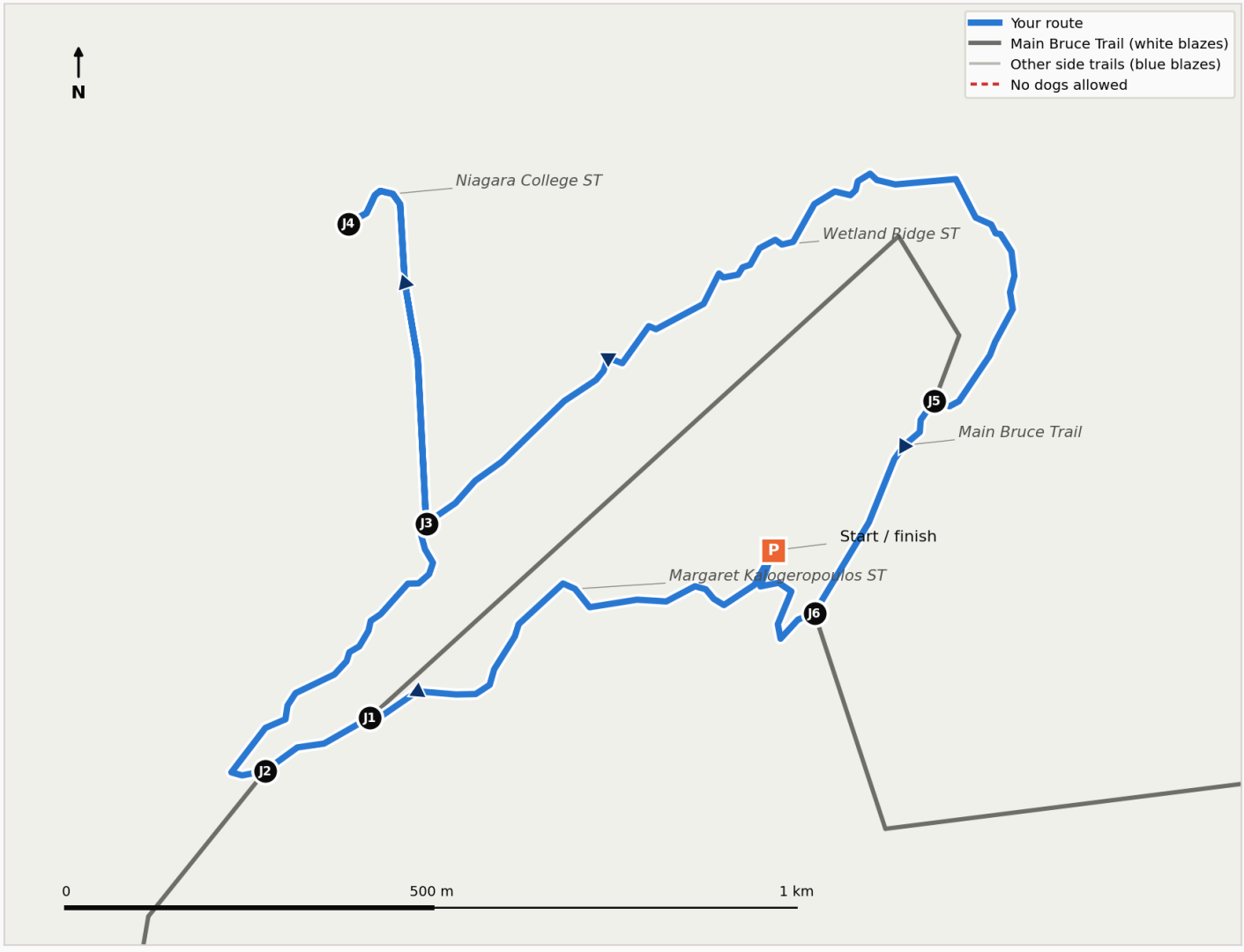
Navigate: import *day03a_hike003.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Wetland Ridge Side Trail (1.9 km); Margaret Kalogeropoulos Side Trail (0.8 km); Niagara College Side Trail (0.5 km)

Same day: this is stop 1 of 2 on day 3 (7.5 mi of hiking, about 171 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 2: hike 4, 4.8 mi from On York Rd (Regional Rd 81), just east of Concession 2.

Route map

Day 3 (stop 1 of 2) | 4.4 km (2.7 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** Woodend Conservation Area is entered from Taylor Rd, 140 m north of Warner Rd. Parking and entry are free, but the lot is limited, so arrive early on weekends.
- **Margaret Kalogeropoulos Side Trail:** This blue-blazed side trail starts with a short road-shoulder stretch; keep Zappy close. It pairs with the main trail for a short loop through shaded hardwood forest with Carolinian trees such as black cherry and sugar maple.
- **Main Bruce Trail:** Runs along the escarpment edge past rock outcrops and a stacked-stone wall. The ground is uneven but the walking is easy. Blazes aren't always on trees, so watch the ground too. Highway noise carries at times.
- **Wetland Ridge & Niagara College Side Trails:** These lead to Niagara College's campus, where old sewage lagoons have become a 7-hectare wetland with interpretive signs. The route passes a First Nations, Métis and Inuit Garden and the college Teaching Winery, which has the area's only washroom.

- **Dogs:** Leashed dogs are welcome on the Bruce Trail. No park-specific dog rules were found.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Woodend Conservation Area: Enter from Taylor Rd, 140 m north of Warner Rd. Walk about 50 m to the trail. Head south-west on the blue-blazed Margaret Kalogeropoulos Side Trail. The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
0.7	0.4	J1: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)
0.9	0.5	J2: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Wetland Ridge Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
1.4	0.9	J3: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Niagara College Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Wetland Ridge Side Trail goes off on your right.)
1.9	1.2	J4: End of the Niagara College Side Trail. Turn around and retrace your steps.
2.5	1.5	J3: Turn sharp left onto the blue-blazed Wetland Ridge Side Trail, heading north-east. (the Wetland Ridge Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
3.8	2.4	J5: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.) There is trailhead parking here (Woodend Conservation Area: Enter from Taylor Rd, 140 m north of Warner Rd).
4.2	2.6	J6: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Margaret Kalogeropoulos Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
4.4	2.7	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on I've Been Bit and Vishwa Walking.